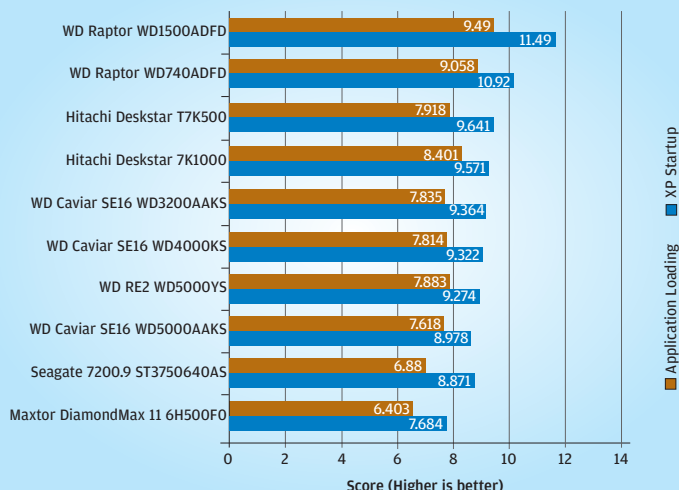
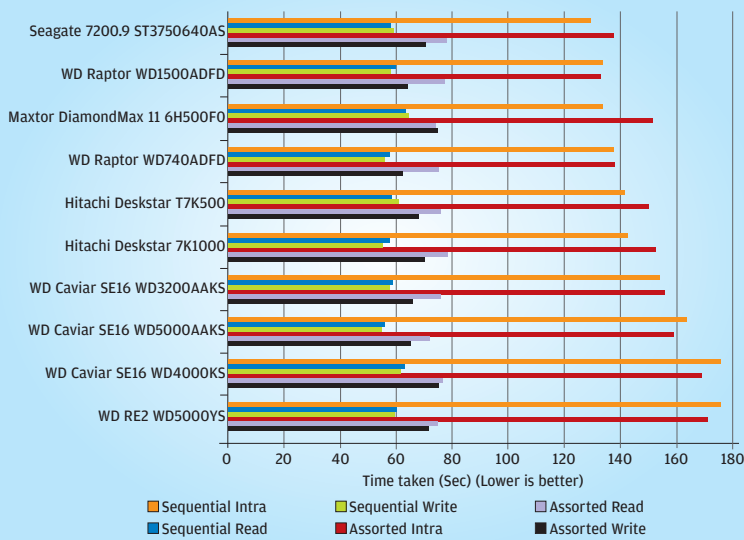


PC Mark 05 Performance Of Top 10 Drives



Real World 4 GB File Transfer Speeds Of Top 10 Drives



it has gotten accustomed—taking just 68.5 seconds. The slowest to open the file was the Samsung HD300LJ, at 1 minute and 47 seconds.

Far Cry level loading times did not reflect too much variation. We probably need bigger levels to load to find a well-defined variation in the game loading times, or a newer game that can take the hard drives of today to their performance limits.

A Few More Things...

For those particular about their PCs being noiseless, we recommend the Seagate and Samsung hard drives. They generated the least amount of noise. When it comes to heating, the Maxtor drives and the WD Raptors would qualify as room-heaters during the winters. While it is understandable that such heat is bound to be produced at 10,000 rpm by the Raptors—they have also been provided heat dissipation fins on the sides—the Maxtor produces an equally large amount of heat for

unknown reasons. These hard drives will therefore require a really well-ventilated cabinet, and the possible addition of active cooling would be helpful.

The Seagate hard drives came with the jumpers set to limit their performance to SATA I. This has been done by Seagate to do away with incompatibilities you would experience if the drive is connected to a SATA I controller. But if you have a motherboard with a SATA II controller, you must remove the jumper to unleash the full potential of the drives.

The Winners

Performance is given the highest importance when it comes to a hard drive buying decision, but price also has to be a factor.

There is no doubt that the Western Digital Raptor drives delivered the best performance, zooming past the others. But these drives are, incidentally, the most expensive, when you consider paise per MB, which is 7.69 for the 150 GB and as high as 10.58 for the 74 GB drive. A regular home user would not spend that much for this amount of storage. Therefore, these drives are only suitable for scenarios such as video capturing, where performance cannot be compromised upon, and when price is not a criterion.

The Hitachi 1 TB provides the ultimate in performance and capacity combined, and is a drive for the mainstream market. But consider this: at Rs 21,000, its price tag is even fatter than its capacity, and we'd advise you to get three 500 GB hard drives, for the same price (assuming your cabinet can take in so many). But as has been the trend, the price will drop steeply.

The Western Digital Caviar SE16 WD3200AAKS is 320 GB, and exhibited excellent performance. The paise per MB is just 1.47. Thus, priced at Rs 4,500, this one means very good value for money and therefore gets the *Digit Best Buy Gold*.

With equally impressive performance scores and a huge 500 GB of space, the Western Digital Caviar SE16 WD5000AAKS has a price per MB of 1.57 paise. Rs 7,500 is not too high for this kind of performance. We decided to award this drive the *Digit Best Buy Silver*.



Western Digital Caviar
SE16 WD5000AAKS
Space, speed and value!